



EXECUTIVE OVERVIEW

LittleSteps Platform Presentation

A practical, role-aware operating portal for early childhood development, school administration, family engagement, and safeguarding.

One connected school experience

FEATURE

One portal, six working areas

LittleSteps brings learning records, care routines, communication, operations, family access, and school administration into a single web experience.

FEATURE

Designed around people

Parents, teachers, principals, district users, and administrators each see the functions relevant to their role and subscription.

FEATURE

Responsive by default

The layout adapts for desktop, tablet, phone, and shared-display use, with a compact tab navigator for smaller screens.

Role-aware access

FEATURE

Parents

View their own child's updates, reports, schedules, alerts, school-store links, and consent choices.

FEATURE

Teachers

Log daily routines, attendance, learning evidence, classroom schedules, supply requests, and parent-ready reports.

FEATURE

Principals and districts

Review school activity, operational records, growth indicators, and approved governance information.

FEATURE

Administrators

Manage accounts, role assignment, school linkage, subscriptions, staff records, notices, and service configuration.

Learning, records, and visibility

FEATURE**Daily care automation**

One-tap meal, nap, mood, toileting and diaper entries reduce repeated manual notes while keeping a clear family update trail.

FEATURE**Schedules and templates**

Teachers can create schedules, download import templates, upload spreadsheet data, and export records for review.

FEATURE**Progress analytics**

Term views calculate improvement or decline, identify strongest and weakest recorded tests, and present parent-ready progress summaries.

FEATURE**Report acknowledgement**

Teacher and parent confirmation can use personal PINs and drawn signatures before a report is marked complete.

Communication that reaches the right people

FEATURE

Activity feed and messaging

Staff group chat, direct conversations, notices, support tickets, and read-aware broadcasts keep day-to-day communication in one place.

FEATURE

Location-aware emergency notices

Area alerts are designed to notify people in the selected area, include a clear sound cue, keep an audit-friendly record, and support removal when no longer needed.

FEATURE

Updates and wellbeing

A dismissible notice board highlights new features; short family advice banners can rotate without disrupting the working screen.

FEATURE

School-specific store

The store points to the school linked to the user. Where no school web store is configured, the portal says so instead of advertising unrelated products.

Safeguarding and responsible data use

FEATURE

Consent choices

Parent onboarding includes separate consent choices for internal learning updates and optional marketing imagery.

FEATURE

Protected records

Medical, emergency-contact, pickup and report data are separated by role. The portal is structured to restrict parent access to their own children and teacher access to assigned classes.

FEATURE

Pickup and incident controls

Pickup details, check-in records, incident forms, medication authorisation, visual allergy flags, PIN checks, and signed acknowledgement support safer daily handovers.

FEATURE

Compliance readiness

Staff verification fields, consent records, access controls, and legal notices support a POPIA- and Children's Act-aware operating approach. A school must still obtain its own legal and security review before production use.

School operations in one place

FEATURE

Accounts and registry

Admins can create, link, rename and manage accounts against a school record, while self-registration supports parents, teachers and principals.

FEATURE

Finance and enrolment

Subscriptions, payment-rule planning, sibling or subsidy considerations, invoicing requirements, and account-level entitlements have a clear home in the portal.

FEATURE

Care, safety and stock

Medication logs, dietary/allergy information, ratio monitoring, incident records, supply requests and stock-intake workflows are accessible to the relevant operational teams.

FEATURE

Nearby school discovery

The 20 km map uses a user's optional location and public OpenStreetMap data to group education facilities, show details when available, and distinguish the user's location.

Subscription-based value

FEATURE

School subscription tiers

Micro/ECD, Standard Primary and Enterprise Campus tiers can be shown with the supplied institutional pricing and operational advantages.

FEATURE

Parent access

A parent's linked school and subscription determine which tabs and detailed features are available. LittleSteps Plus is positioned for enhanced family features, including richer progress insight.

FEATURE

Feature gates

The navigation and page actions can be hidden or shown by role and subscription instead of presenting unavailable tools.

FEATURE

Integration boundaries

Payments, Google/Yahoo/Microsoft sign-in, SMS, push notifications and external payroll connections require provider configuration, account approval and production security work.

A reliable route to production

FEATURE**1. Secure foundation**

Use HTTPS, managed identity, server-enforced permissions, secure secret storage, backups, retention controls and audit logging.

FEATURE**2. Configure the school**

Create the school record, approve account roles, set subscription rules, add trusted staff and define consent and pickup practices.

FEATURE**3. Train by role**

Use the illustrated guide, schedule templates and staged onboarding so staff learn only the workflows they need.

FEATURE**4. Connect services**

Enable verified email/SMS/push, payment, payroll or identity providers only after a school has approved the appropriate contracts and data-processing arrangements.

A transparent commercial model

FEATURE

Two-week trial

Offer a 14-day guided trial with a clearly scoped sandbox, onboarding support and no production child-data migration until the school approves go-live.

FEATURE

30-day money-back commitment

A 30-day money-back guarantee can be offered from paid activation, subject to published eligibility, refund process and consumer-law review.

FEATURE

36-month agreement

The proposed school agreement has a 36-month term. Pricing, renewal, service scope, data export and early-exit terms must be accepted in writing.

FEATURE

Fixed charges

Cancellation requires two months' advance notice and is calculated from the school plan. Post-contract customisation work is quoted as a fixed plan-based fee before work begins.

Finance without manual reconciliation

FEATURE

Payment reliability

Use recurring debit/card collection with monitored failed payments, configurable retry timing, clear family notices and a finance-team review queue.

FEATURE

Flexible parent billing

Support split-custody payers, partial government subsidies, sibling discounts, payment plans and school-approved exceptions through auditable invoice rules.

FEATURE

Accounting integrations

Send approved payment, refund and invoice events to configured Xero, Sage or QuickBooks connectors so finance teams do not reconcile each transaction manually.

FEATURE

Controls and limits

Each provider integration needs its own contract, API credentials, reconciliation testing, data-processing assessment and failure-handling process before launch.

A calmer navigation experience

FEATURE

Categorised sidebar

Replace 23+ horizontal tabs with a responsive category menu: Academics, Family, Finance, Operations, Safety, Administration and Help. Keep a compact mobile drawer for small screens.

FEATURE

Relevant work only

Parents, teachers, principals, districts and departments receive only the categories, events, records and actions needed for their role.

FEATURE

Fitted dashboards

Use responsive cards, summary counts, action queues and contextual shortcuts so dashboards fit on phone, tablet, desktop and shared displays without overlap.

FEATURE

Accessible theme

White mode must maintain readable text and contrast. Validate labels, inputs, notices and map popups in both themes before release.

Trusted records from the start

FEATURE

Unique data basis

Use primary keys, foreign keys and server-side unique constraints to prevent duplicate accounts, child records, imports and documents. Show a clear 'Duplicate record already exists' message.

FEATURE

Random identifier service

Generate collision-resistant record codes server-side and never use a visible random number alone as an authority or access credential.

FEATURE

Import review

For photo/OCR or template imports, extract supported fields, show a review screen, require 'Are you sure?', and offer Edit before any record is submitted.

FEATURE

Form library

Provide required field forms and CSV/Excel/PDF-compatible templates per workflow, plus a controlled form-template editor for approved school-specific versions.

Continuity when the primary service is unavailable

FEATURE

Primary and recovery environment

Host encrypted operational data in managed primary storage and a tested backup/recovery environment with documented recovery point and recovery-time objectives.

FEATURE

Replication

Continuously replicate essential records with monitored lag and conflict controls. Test attendance and incident write paths during a planned failover; asynchronous replication cannot promise zero loss.

FEATURE

Automatic routing

Use Cloudflare or Route 53 health checks and load-balancer failover so the normal school address routes to the healthy service without asking teachers to type a raw backup URL.

FEATURE

Maintenance status

A global banner and live status signal can announce planned work, expected impact and the approved backup-service route when necessary.

Errors that are actionable, not alarming

FEATURE

Express middleware

Capture exceptions in central Node/Express error middleware, assign a unique code such as ERR-AUTH-001 or ERR-DB-502, and record safe execution context for administrators.

FEATURE

Right information for each role

Staff see a calm message and Support Desk action. Administrators see the correlation code, event time, safe diagnostic details and protected source context where authorised.

FEATURE

Help Desk handoff

The client can direct a user to Support Desk with an error reference. Avoid exposing stack traces, database names, tokens or sensitive child data in browser messages.

FEATURE

Operational monitoring

Track error rate, severity, code frequency, maintenance state and recovery status through protected monitoring - not through an unprotected public page.

Child identity with privacy safeguards

FEATURE

Encrypted personal information

Encrypt child names, identifiers, medical details and sensitive contacts in transit and at rest, with managed keys, access logging, retention rules and least-privilege access.

FEATURE

School-issued child code

Assign a non-predictable child reference code for physical registers. Entering the code identifies the record only after an authorised user is authenticated; the code must not replace access control.

FEATURE

Required school fields

The child profile form includes grade, class, identity and contact data, care and medical flags, authorised pickups, consent choices and school-required forms.

FEATURE

Recovery and exports

Admins can revoke a lost code and issue a replacement with an audit trail. Generate carefully controlled PDF, CSV and Excel code-register templates for authorised physical recordkeeping.

Safe school discovery and applications

FEATURE

School information

Map data should use verified public sources, label missing details honestly and avoid inventing contacts. Only public building or campus photos may be displayed - never child photos.

FEATURE

Apply or link

A map pin can offer Apply or Link to School. The request contains the approved application form and is delivered by authorised email or in-portal notification.

FEATURE

Two-way approval

The receiving school verifies or declines the request before creating the active relationship. Applicants can see status without gaining school data prematurely.

FEATURE

Department-aware setup

Configure education, administration, finance, human resources, care/safety, operations, stock, communication and support roles per school. Do not enable a department merely because the tab exists.

Defence against account and data misuse

FEATURE

Suspicious activity response

Detect excessive child-record queries, repeated failed logins or abnormal exports. Notify authorised administrators/principals with the account, IP, event timing and affected service context.

FEATURE

Immediate account containment

Revoke server-side sessions/JWTs, cancel authorised download streams, block further API access, and push a locked-screen state. A browser app cannot turn off a device's physical internet connection.

FEATURE

Investigate before broad shutdown

Use rate limits, IP/WAF controls, audit evidence and an incident workflow. Avoid automatically taking every school user offline without a documented risk decision and incident authority.

FEATURE

Section 22 workflow

Provide an incident-report pack for the responsible party and information officer. Where there are reasonable grounds for unauthorised access or acquisition, POPIA section 22 requires notification of the Information Regulator and affected data subjects as soon as reasonably possible, subject to the Act and legal advice.

People and compliance never expire silently

FEATURE

HR compliance vault

Store approved First Aid, criminal-clearance and ECD-qualification records with document dates, owner, verification state and protected access.

FEATURE

30-day expiry warnings

Notify administrators 30 days before a monitored credential expires and show an action queue for renewal, verification, suspension or escalation.

FEATURE

Staff-to-child monitoring

Track checked-in children and available staff against school-set room ratios, surfacing exceptions to authorised supervisors.

FEATURE

Safeguarding boundaries

Credential monitoring supports school governance but does not verify a qualification, clearance or legal right to work by itself. The school must complete the required checks.